

STRATEGY

When Your Whole Year Happens in Three Months

By Scott Tischler · October 8, 2026 · 8 min read

Here is the direct answer: **AI visibility accumulates slowly and continuously, which is exactly out of phase with how a seasonal business operates.** If you publish only when you are busy, you are building authority during the months when the answer has already been given, and going quiet during the months when it is being formed.

Tax preparers, landscapers, pool companies, ski shops, wedding services, tourism operators, holiday retail — the pattern is the same. Everything happens in a compressed window, and the instinct is to market inside that window. By then, the models have largely settled who they name.

Why the timing works against you

Corroboration takes time to accumulate and longer to be absorbed. A page published in your peak week is competing for attention at the moment competition is highest, and it has no history behind it.

Meanwhile the questions do not actually stop in the off-season. They change. Nobody is asking who to hire this week; they are asking what it costs, when to book, whether it is worth it, how to choose, and what goes wrong. Those questions run year-round at lower volume and they are the ones that decide who gets named later, because they are where someone forms a view before they are ready to act.

The off-season is not low demand. It is early-stage demand, which is cheaper to win and compounds into the season.

What to publish when nobody is buying

- **The decision questions.** How to choose a provider, what separates a good job from a bad one, what the common mistakes are. These get read by people months before they buy and they establish you as the explainer rather than the vendor.
- **Honest pricing.** What it costs and what drives the range. Perennially asked, perennially dodged, and the business that answers plainly tends to become the cited source.

- **Timing guidance.** When to book, when it is too late, why the window is what it is. This is genuinely useful and it is a question only an insider can answer.
- **The off-season service nobody knows you offer.** Many seasonal businesses do something in the quiet months and never mention it, which is both lost revenue and a missed reason to publish.
- **Last season, honestly reviewed.** What changed, what surprised you, what you would tell someone differently this year. Nobody else can write it, which makes it exactly the kind of thing that gets cited.

The maintenance that matters more than the content

One specific failure is worth isolating, because it is common and it is self-inflicted: letting the business look dormant.

Hours that show closed indefinitely. A site with a banner about last season. Profiles not updated since the last peak. A system assessing whether you are currently operating has to make a judgment, and all of those point the wrong way.

If you genuinely close, say so explicitly with dates and when you reopen, rather than letting the absence of information imply you are gone. "Closed for the season, reopening in March, taking bookings now" is a completely different signal from silence, and it costs one sentence.

The counter-cyclical trade

Your competitors are doing the same thing you are: going quiet. Which makes the off-season the cheapest time to accumulate the corroboration that decides the next peak, because the field is empty and attention is cheap.

That is the actual argument here. Not that you should work year-round for its own sake, but that the marginal return on a published page is probably highest at the moment it feels most pointless. My read, not a guarantee — but the mechanism is straightforward enough that I would act on it.

A workable cadence

You do not need peak-season volume in the off-season. You need continuity. A piece or two a month through the quiet period, answering the questions people ask before they are ready, plus profiles that clearly state you are operating and bookable, puts you in a materially different position by the time the season arrives.

And it has a second benefit worth naming: it spreads the work across the year, so the content is not competing for your attention during the twelve weeks when you are actually delivering the service. The business case and the operational case point the same way.

Key takeaways

- ♦ AI visibility accumulates continuously, which is out of phase with seasonal operations.
- ♦ Off-season demand is early-stage demand, not low demand — and it decides who gets named later.
- ♦ Publish decision questions, honest pricing and timing guidance when nobody is buying.
- ♦ Never let profiles imply dormancy; state closure dates and reopening explicitly.
- ♦ Competitors go quiet at the same time, making the off-season the cheapest window to accumulate authority.
- ♦ A piece or two a month sustains continuity and keeps content off your peak-season plate.

Frequently asked questions

Should a seasonal business market during its off-season?

Yes, though not at peak volume. The off-season carries early-stage demand — people asking what it costs, when to book and how to choose — and those questions shape who gets named once buying starts. A piece or two a month is enough to maintain continuity.

What happens if my profiles show the business as closed?

A system assessing whether you are operating will take indefinite closure at face value. State it explicitly instead: closed for the season, reopening on a named date, taking bookings now. That is a completely different signal from silence and costs one sentence.

Is it too late to start if my season is already underway?

Not useless, but the return is lower, because the sources that shape answers largely accumulated earlier. Publish what you can now, and treat the coming off-season as the real opportunity — it is when your competitors go quiet and attention is cheapest.

About the author. Scott Tischler is the Founder & Chairman of Alrecommend.ai and a practitioner-authority on AI search and Answer Engine Optimization. With 20+ years in marketing technology — including American Express, MetLife, and UBS — and executive and professional study at Wharton, Harvard, and Oxford, he helps businesses become the ones AI recommends.